

2026 Headcount Plan

Owner: Sofia Marques, Head of People, with FP&A **Approved by:** Maya Okafor (CEO) on 22 January 2026; mid-year update approved on 20 July 2026 **Classification:** HR Confidential

1. Summary

Northwind Labs started 2026 with 402 employees. The original plan approved in January targeted 468 employees at 31 December 2026 (66 net new hires). At the mid-year update the target was lowered to **455 employees**, a net increase of 53 over the year, to align with the revised FY2026 forecast. As of 30 June 2026 the company had 421 employees.

Hiring is prioritized for Engineering (Atlas 5 and Beacon reliability) and EMEA sales capacity in Berlin. Backfills for regretted attrition are approved automatically; all other requisitions require approval in Workday by the department VP and the Head of People.

2. Headcount by department

Department	1 Jan 2026	30 Jun 2026	Year-end target (revised)	Net change 2026
Engineering	168	175	189	+21
Product	18	19	21	+3
Sales	74	79	86	+12
Marketing	24	25	27	+3
Customer Success	52	54	59	+7
People	14	14	15	+1
Finance & Legal	19	20	21	+2
IT & Security	15	16	18	+3
Executive	18	19	19	+1
Total	402	421	455	+53

3. Headcount by office

Office	30 Jun 2026	Year-end target
Lisbon (HQ)	168	178
Berlin	92	104
Austin	81	87
Kraków	47	50
Remote (EU and US)	33	36
Total	421	455

4. Hiring rules for the second half

- Requisitions not opened by 30 September 2026 are moved to the 2027 plan.
- Kraków expansion hiring is frozen until 2027; backfills only.
- Contractors converting to employees count against the department target.
- Attrition target: below 12% voluntary attrition (trailing twelve months: 10.8% as of June 2026).

5. Open priorities

1. Engineering: 6 senior engineers for Beacon on-call reliability, 4 for Atlas ingestion.
2. Sales: 5 Account Executives in Berlin for the DACH and Nordics territories.
3. Customer Success: 3 Technical Account Managers for Enterprise customers.

Recruiting status is reviewed every two weeks in the People leadership meeting.